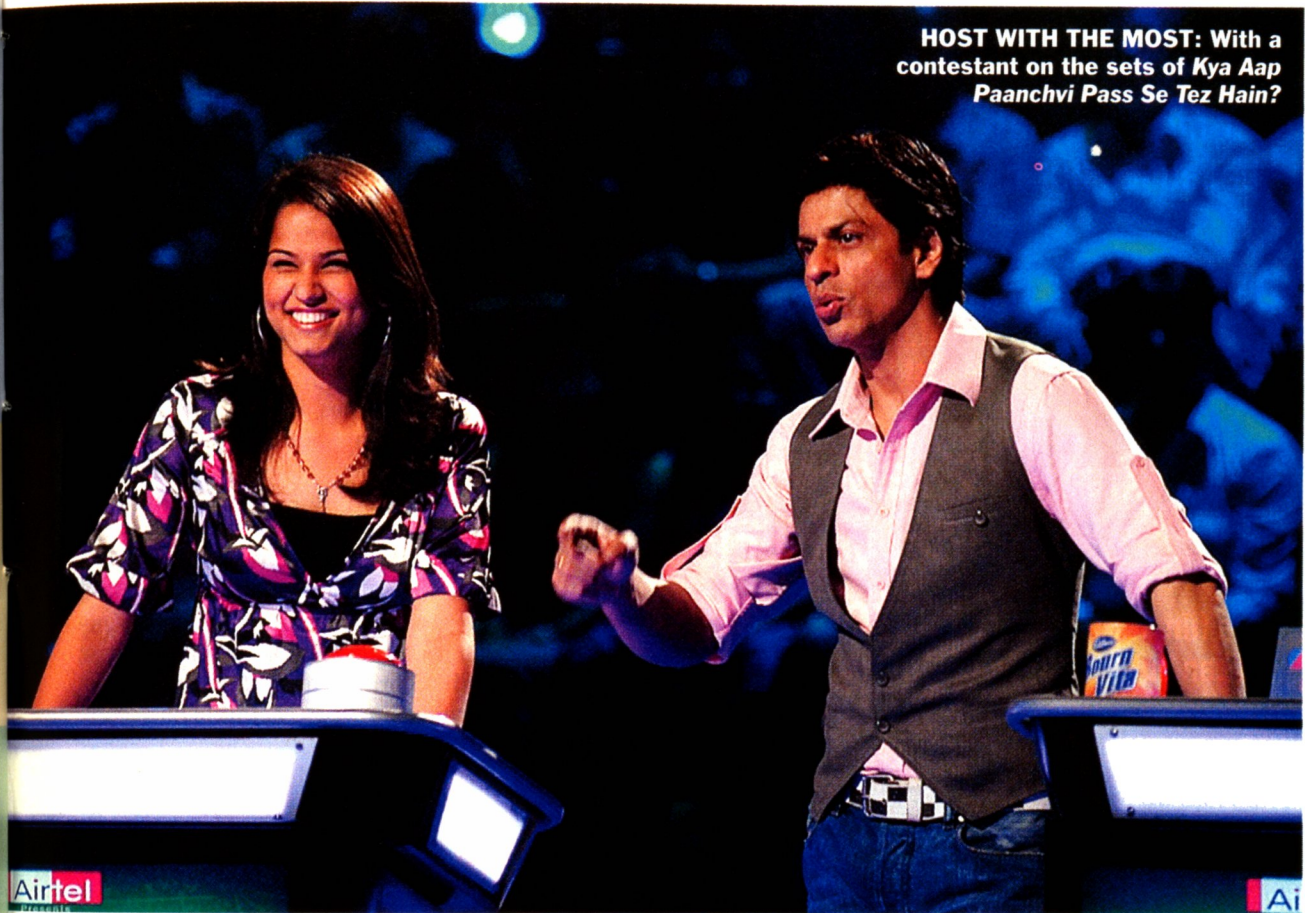


HOST WITH THE MOST: With a contestant on the sets of *Kya Aap Paanchvi Pass Se Tez Hain?*



WHERE HE scores is in his ability to reinvent himself in various arenas. From the inspirational coach in *Chak De! India* to the teacher with the smarts in *Paanchvi Pass*, he is the centre of his own universe.

along with work on a quick comedy with Priyadarshan, and then on May 15, he starts filming Aditya Chopra's *Rab Ne Bana Di Jodi*. "I haven't slept since January 21, the day I bought the team," says the man now better known by his snappy initials.

What's fuelling all this? A handful of chicken tikkas, two biscuits, half a club sandwich, four glasses of Pepsi and a couple of cups of black coffee? Or the desperate desire to attain immortality as his reign over Bollywood nears its end? An actor is, after all, known by the movies he does, something that Amitabh Bachchan realised after the debacle of ABCL when he had to travel the distance to Yash Chopra's home one morning and ask for work. At the heart of Shah Rukh Khan Inc—in the past two years, the actor has earned over Rs 270

crore from movie fees, endorsements and television anchoring—is a 42-year-old who can't keep still, whose every minute has to be accounted for by some project, for whom the pressure of an enforced eight-month holiday after *Om Shanti Om* must have stretched like a gigantic question mark when films with southern director Shankar and *Munnabhai* director Raju Hirani did not work out. But now with a Rs 300-crore investment in the Indian Premier League (IPL) team over 10 years (an annual investment of \$15.5 million, Rs 63 crore, is expected to give the Knight Riders a return of \$12.5 million—around Rs 50 crore—in the first year

itself), he has expanded his empire to include virtually every aspect of entertainment. While his Red Chillies Entertainment has a bustling vfx (visual effects) department and produces almost all his advertisements, his live shows, handled by Cineyug, also form a profitable business. The last Temptations tour of the US in 2004, for instance, netted a revenue of \$15 million (Rs 61 crore). If Bachchan at the peak of his career was a one-man industry, Shah Rukh Khan is one man, many small-scale industries. Or as he puts it better: "I am just an employee of the Shah Rukh Khan myth." As his IPL partners and

Rs 36 cr
earnings from 36 episodes of *Kya Aap Paanchvi Pass Se Tez Hain?*